of ten Pa-O youth aged between twelve and sixteen attended the English reading class. Later, they were shown a video called *Vote for Me*, which was about how to choose a class representative in school.[17]

The new political culture is also being constantly reaffirmed through cross-fertilization. Ceremonies marking the anniversary of the 1988 democracy movement are a case in point. At the 2014 occasion, KRSAN led a group of Pa-O youth to attend the event, and during the ceremony, they led the delegates in singing songs about democracy. At the end, they boarded two trucks and headed towards Taunggyi town centre to continue singing about democracy. From the activities of KRSAN and other CSOs, it appears that grassroots resistance to the political order in southern Shan State has emerged from the sponsorship of international actors. This movement's political economy is independent from the state, and therefore they are able to claim the moral high ground. International actors are linked to the local political order by providing the impetus to undermine the authority of the pro-establishment camp, thereby indirectly reinforcing other pro-democracy actors outside the Pa-O to form a united front to challenge the agents of the state (Figure 5.3). Therefore, it comes as no surprise that the PNO declared KRSAN as an "enemy of the party" during its general meeting on 14 December 2014.[18]

Figure 5.3. A different political economy driving power from the bottom

